

Managing Flare Weeks

A practical, clinician-built guide for living with endometriosis

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Why this guide exists

I am a nurse practitioner in women's health, and I also live with Stage III endometriosis. The advice here is the same I give the people I care about. It is education, not a substitute for your own clinician, but it is honest about what actually helps when a flare hits.

Know your pattern before the flare arrives

Most people with endometriosis flare in a recognizable rhythm. Track pain on a simple 0 to 10 scale, note what you took and when, and watch for the two or three days each month that consistently cost you the most. A pattern you can see is a pattern you can plan around.

Build a flare-week kit

Keep your tools in one place so you are not hunting for them in pain. A heating pad, your prescribed anti-inflammatory, electrolyte drinks, easy anti-inflammatory meals you batched ahead, loose clothing, and a short list of gentle movements. Restorative yoga and walking beat pushing through a hard workout.

Medication timing matters

If your clinician has you on a continuous hormonal therapy, take it at the same time daily. For breakthrough pain, do not wait until the pain is at its worst. Used early and within the dose your clinician set, a scheduled anti-inflammatory window through the heaviest days works better than chasing pain after it spikes.

Protect your sleep and your calendar

Flares disrupt sleep, and poor sleep feeds pain. Where you can, move heavy commitments off your predictable hard days. Telling a partner or a friend in advance is not weakness, it is logistics.

When to call your clinician

Escalating pain that breaks through your usual plan, new or changing symptoms, or pain that keeps you from normal life is worth a call. Tracking gives you the language to make that call quickly.

Free companion tracker and more guides at heather-cole.com. Questions: hello@heather-cole.com.